

Build shelter before advancing the king

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

In rook endings, a king supporting a passed pawn may be exposed to endless checks. A useful winning plan often creates shelter with the rook or pawn before the king steps forward. Familiar bridge-building ideas must be matched to exact positions.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A rook can move to a rank where it will later interpose against checks, allowing the king to advance. If the rook moves too early and loses the pawn or permits a checking skewer, the plan fails.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you verify in a bridge-building plan?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The defender's checking routes, the pawn's safety, and a legal interposition square after the king advances. Calculate the checks instead of assuming a memorized setup applies.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Prepare an answer to checks before moving into them.